

31 Canadian Brigade Group: Magazine Draft Outline

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General Details

Magazine Pages: 12

The Magazine will consolidate the Brigade's information as an initial and introductory product to internal stakeholders and for the public as a recruiting tool. Gathering information from 2023 to present.

The USARPAC September 2023 Edition Magazine will serve as the design inspiration for the 31 CBG booklet.

Headers: Front Page, Foreword, Vision & Mission, Who we are, Subordinate Units, AO Map, Domestic and International Operations, Strong. Proud. Ready (Brigade's vision for the next few years), Sources, highlights/optional page.

Page	Header	Content
Front Page	Large Header: 31 Canadian Brigade Group 31CBG	Selection of photos and a noticeable header.
1	Contents	Short list of content contained within magazine. To eventually include printing and media information.
2	Foreword	Includes introduction explaining the intent of the magazine, the content to be found and a short note directed at the members of 31 CBG.
3	Vision & Mission	Examples of the Brigade's Vision and Mission (created by me)
4	Who we are	Introduces the Brigade to the reader. General overview of Brigade history and facts.
5-6	Subordinate Units	Survey and overview of the Brigade's 12 units. Includes general history, locations and recent operations.
7-8	AO Map	Presents a map of Southwestern Ontario with key locations, units and

		military symbols. Ensure opsec is maintained.
9-10	Exercises & Domestic Operations	Highlight and list with information Operations soldiers from 31 have participated in. Opsec critical in this portion.
11-12	Strong. Proud. Ready & Highlights	Brigade's outreach activities and public engagements examples. Showcase exercises and photos of 31 Brigade soldiers.
13	Sources and Further Reading Page.	Includes sources and citations to source material.
Back Cover Page	Back Cover Page	Information on the 31 Brigade insignia, a large photo, social media links and a PDF link to access Magazine online.

Approximate Word Count: 5250

Notes/Quotes

Quote to include somewhere:

"At the end of his long life, one of the Regiment's most distinguished sons turned increasingly to his days as an Argyll and thought little of anything else. Some years earlier, Claude Bissell, a long-time president of the University of Toronto." "Infantry regiments," he thought, "invite this kind of consideration; for an infantry regiment consists of little except human beings... The infantry regiment is the queen of battle; it is also the working man with an eternal chip on his shoulder and an indestructible core of cynicism and self-satisfaction."

- Claude Bissel (1916 to 2000), Canadian author and educator.

(Front Page)

Large Header: 31 Canadian Brigade Group

31CBG

Assortment of Photos

(Block organization similar USARPAC mag)

Bottom Block and subheader: *Approved for Public Release | Distribution Unlimited*

4 Division's Reserve Brigade Group, encompassing southwestern Ontario.

September 202

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(Page 2 - Foreword)

(Alternative: The history of citizen soldiery in Canada stretches back centuries, predating even Confederation. Throughout the country's history, local inhabitants played a vital role in defending their communities. This tradition of citizen soldiers continued to evolve, culminating in the formation of the modern Canadian Army Reserve in the 19th century.)

The history of citizen soldiery in Canada stretches back centuries and is deeply woven into the fabric of the nation. Long before Confederation in 1867, the need for local defense saw communities' band together to protect their families and homes(*). This tradition evolved from early European settlement, where inhabitants, both Indigenous and European, participated in safeguarding their homes. Throughout the centuries, this commitment to community defense morphed into a formalized militia system, eventually culminating in the modern Canadian Army Reserve in the 19th century (*).

Today, the Reserve Force serves as an integral component of the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF), providing critical operational support in times of crisis or need. While a part-time service, the Army Reserve generates full-time capabilities allowing members to choose to serve either from home or abroad. As a vital part of the Army, Reservists benefit from its unique work experience, sense of belonging and camaraderie, while drawing on a wealth of experience and skills from the civilian world.

Subheader: *For Hearth and Home, 31 Canadian Brigade Group*

Established in 1994, 31 Canadian Brigade Group (31CBG) boasts a rich history of service, contributing to both domestic and international operations. As an Army Reserve Formation headquartered in London, the Brigade area of responsibility reaches across southwestern Ontario. In recent years, the Brigade has deployed hundreds of soldiers to overseas operations in Afghanistan, Iraq, the Democratic Republic of Congo, the UK and Eastern Europe. Domestically, the Brigade has also supported and provided personnel to civilian authorities during times of crisis, such as supporting civilian authorities during the Covid-19 pandemic. From rendering vital assistance during local disasters to deploying with distinction on international missions, 31 CBG exemplifies the unwavering dedication and professionalism that defines Canada's citizen soldiers.

This magazine seeks to recognize the rich history of the Brigade, highlight its current operations and activities, celebrate members successes and to overall demonstrate 31 Canadian Brigade Group's commitment to the defense of Canada and of all Canadians. As 31 CBG continues its proud legacy of service, this magazine will document our journey and inspire future generations of soldiers.

Dedicated to the soldiers of 31CBG. Pro Aris et Focis. - (Possible Quote from Brigade Commander or from Div commander. Alternatively, a quote from a significant figure in our history.) *"Infantry regiments," he thought, "invite this kind of consideration; for an infantry*

regiment consists of little except human beings... The infantry regiment is the queen of battle; it is also the working man with an eternal chip on his shoulder and an indestructible core of cynicism and self-satisfaction."

- Claude Bissel (1916 to 2000), Canadian author and educator.

(Page 3 – Vision and Mission)

Picture with Vision/Mission to the left or right.

Include Motto on page: *Pro Aris et Focis*.

Vision:

31 Canadian Brigade Group is committed to domestic and international readiness by providing a highly trained, adaptable, and mission-ready Army Reserve Formation, serving as the cornerstone of land force preparedness in southwestern Ontario and a source of national pride for Canadians.

Mission:

31 Canadian Brigade Group supports 4 Division to generate and train a highly capable and well-equipped Reserve force to augment the Canadian Army, provide domestic security, and support international operations in defense of Canada and its interests.

(Page 4 – Who We Are)

31 Canadian Brigade Group (31CBG) is an Army Reserve formation headquartered in London, Ontario, with an area of responsibility that encompasses Southwestern Ontario. Stretching from Hamilton to Windsor and north to Owen Sound and Barrie, the Brigade has nearly 2500 members of whom the vast majority are part-time Reservist soldiers.

Established in 1994, 31 CBG has a long and distinguished history of service to Canada, contributing to both domestic and international operations. The Brigade has deployed hundreds of soldiers on international operations in Afghanistan, Iraq, the UK and Eastern Europe. Notably, 31 CBG personnel have served in numerous capacities in Afghanistan, including as part of Operation ATTENTION, Canada's past contribution to the NATO Training Mission Afghanistan (2009 to 2014). As well as more recent operations such as Op IMPACT in Lebanon, Jordan, Kuwait and Iraq as part Canada's whole-of-government approach to the Middle East.

31 Canadian Brigade Group (31 CBG) is a vital asset in providing domestic support to civilian authorities during times of crisis, deploying only when officially requested. This ensures a coordinated and efficient response, leveraging the unique skillsets and resources of the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF) to complement existing civilian efforts. Throughout its history, 31 CBG has demonstrated its commitment to safeguarding Canadian communities by deploying numerous soldiers in various domestic operations. These deployments have aided Canadians facing diverse challenges across the country.

One notable example is the extensive flood control operations in the Chatham-Kent area in 2019. 31 CBG soldiers were instrumental in constructing and reinforcing flood barriers, evacuating residents from vulnerable areas, and providing logistical support to affected communities. Their efforts mitigated the impact of the flooding and ensured the safety of countless residents. Equally, during the COVID-19 Pandemic, 31 CBG played a crucial role in Canada's response. Soldiers were deployed to long-term care facilities experiencing outbreaks, providing much-needed support to overwhelmed healthcare workers. They assisted with patient care, logistical tasks, and infection control measures, helping to contain the spread of the virus and safeguard vulnerable populations.

These examples are just a snapshot of the diverse domestic operations that 31 CBG has participated in. Their contributions have ranged from disaster relief and humanitarian aid to supporting law enforcement and protecting critical infrastructure.

31 Canadian Brigade Group is composed of twelve units located across Southwestern Ontario. These units are spread out in London, Stratford, St. Thomas, Sarnia, Windsor, Chatham, Hamilton, Burlington, Waterloo, Guelph, Cambridge, Kitchener, Owen Sound and Barrie.

- 1st Hussars
- The Windsor Regiment
- 11th Field Artillery Regiment

- 31 Combat Engineer Regiment
- 31 Signal Regiment
- The Royal Hamilton Light Infantry
- 4th Battalion, The Royal Canadian Regiment
- The Royal Highland Fusiliers of Canada
- The Grey and Simcoe Foresters
- The Essex and Kent Scottish
- The Argyll and Sutherland Highlanders of Canada
- 31 Service Battalion

31 CBG is more than just a military formation; it is a family of soldiers, united by a shared commitment to service and a deep sense of camaraderie.

The Brigade's motto, "Pro Aris et Focis" (For Hearth and Home), reflects this commitment to defending Canada and its values. Whether serving on domestic operations or deploying overseas, the soldiers of 31 CBG exemplify the best of the Canadian Army Reserve. Their dedication, professionalism, and unwavering commitment to duty make them an invaluable asset to the Canadian Armed Forces and a source of pride for all Canadians.

(Fact Bubble – to be included somewhere on page): 31 Canada Brigade Group Insignia: Gules an arrowhead Argent charged with a maple leaf Gules. The Brigade's official insignia received approval and adoption on May 1, 1998. The arrowhead recalls the former badge of the Western Ontario Area Headquarters.

Subheader: Division

4TH Canadian Division (4 Cdn Div)

The 4th Canadian Division (4 Cdn Div) is one of the five major formations that report to Army headquarters in Ottawa. 4 Cdn Div is responsible to provide combat ready land forces in accordance with assigned tasks, conduct general purpose training in preparation for various land operations, and provide support services to other organizations as directed or as mutually arranged. It includes all Regular and Reserve Force units in Ontario. to generate and maintain, at designated states of readiness, combat ready, multi-purpose land forces to meet Canada's defence objectives, both at home and abroad. 4 Cdn Div is spread across 46 Ontario communities and comprises more than 13,000 men and women. 4Cdn Div HQ is located in Toronto, with the Div overseeing three major Army formations: 31 CBG, 32 CBG, and 33 CBG.

Subheader: Brigade Command

31 Canadian Brigade Group (HQ) (London)

Headquarters are not considered to have lineages similar to military units. 31 Canadian Brigade Group Headquarters does, however, continue a heritage of military headquarters in London which have, for over a century, commanded units of the Canadian Army in South-Western Ontario. Depending on the Army's organization, the various headquarters that have been located in London have seen changes in the number of units and the size of the area of the operational responsibility they commanded. As early as 1860s, the number of Militia units throughout the Canadian provinces outgrew the span of control possible for single centralized headquarters, and a more comprehensive command structure required. In 1868, a system of Military Districts was created and assigned the responsibility of overseeing the training and coordinating the administrative of Milita units in their assigned areas. These Military Districts were further divided into 'Brigade Divisions.'

Subheader: Service and Support

The role of service and support in the Army is to provide essential logistics, maintenance and administrative functions that enable combat units to operate effectively. While the job of service and support personnel may not always be as visible as that of front-line soldiers, it is no less critical to the overall success of military operations. Service and support personnel ensure that soldiers have the supplies, equipment, and support they need to accomplish their missions, often working tirelessly behind the scenes to keep the organization running smoothly.

31 Service Battalion (Windsor, Hamilton, London)

31 Service Battalion is a unique element of the Canadian Forces, whose task is to augment Canada's military by providing Combat Service Support soldiers. The battalion has approximately 300 soldiers, both Regular Force and Reserve Force. It is organized into a Battalion HQ, an HQ Company, Technical Services Platoon and London Support Company are located primarily in London, with the other support companies in Windsor and Hamilton. 31 Service Battalion is one of the largest reserve units in all of Canada and has thrived in a time of great change and challenge. The greatest strength of the Battalion is the soldiers who do the dirty and dangerous work in difficult conditions both in Canada and around the globe.

31 Service Battalion's motto is "Bellum est Cras" which translates as "The War is Tomorrow"; a reflection of the Battalion's commitment to preparing for and conducting operations of any nature, anytime.

31 Signal Regiment (Hamilton and London)

31 Signal Regiment is a Communications unit located in both Hamilton and London Ontario. The Regiment provides expedient and reliable wired and wireless communication, using advanced voice and data systems to Canada's military. 31 Signal Regiment was the 1st Wireless Detachment Unit in Canada, providing radio communications during the first and second World Wars, going through several name changes.

31 Signals Regiment motto is "Velox Versutus Vigilans," which translates as "Swift, Skilled, Vigilant." This motto reflects the Regiment commitment to providing timely, effective, and reliable communications support to the Canadian Armed Forces, ensuring that commanders have the information they need to make critical decisions on the battlefield.

Subheader: Infantry

The role of the infantry is to close-with and destroy the enemy: often under challenging conditions. While the job of an infantryman is a demanding one, it is also a highly rewarding, exciting and fun career, offering a highly supportive and close-knit family network to all its members.

4th Battalion, The Royal Canadian Regiment (London and Stratford)

The 4th Battalion, The Royal Canadian Regiment (4 RCR) is an infantry unit based in London and Stratford, ON. The RCR was founded on 21 December 1883 as Canada's first truly professional regiment of infantry and has fought gallantly in every conflict Canada has been involved in. 4 RCR specifically, has drawn its soldiers from the London, Woodstock and Stratford area for more than 150 years. Today, 4 RCR is a proud and active unit that strives to set the example in all matters of leadership and soldiering. 4 RCR's role is to rigorously train its soldiers and officers, as part of 31 Canadian Brigade

Group, to be ready for operations both domestically and around the world. The unit, in the past, committed more than 20% of its strength to Canadian operations in Afghanistan and nowadays actively augments operations domestically and in Europe.

4 RCR's motto is "Pro Patria," which translates as "For Country." This motto reflects the Battalion's unwavering commitment to serving and defending Canada, its values, and its interests, both at home and abroad.

The Essex and Kent Scottish (Windsor and Chatham)

The Essex and Kent Scottish is a Primary Reserve unit located in Windsor and Chatham, whose task is to augment Canada's military with trained infantry soldiers. The Essex and Kent Scottish is a regiment with old lineage that can be dated back to 1749 as a French militia at Fort Pontchartrain (Detroit), although it has unbroken lineage dating to 12 June 1885. Essex and Kent counties produced the first militia organization in Ontario and the first units to engage in combat (1794) outside Canada. The Essex and Kent Scottish is always hiring intelligent, fit, and confident men and women with an interest in dynamic and challenging training as infantry soldiers.

The Essex and Kent Scottish's motto is "Semper Paratus," which translates as "Always Ready." This motto reflects the Regiment's commitment to maintaining a high state of readiness, ensuring that they are prepared to deploy and defend Canada and its interests at a moment's notice.

The Argyll and Sutherland Highlanders of Canada (Princess Louise's) (Hamilton)

The Argyll and Sutherland Highlanders of Canada (ASHC) IS Primary Reserve infantry regiment of the Canadian Army. Located in Hamilton, Ontario, the regiment is part of 31 CBG. The Argylls are a proud regiment with a rich history dating back to 1903. The unit's lineage can be traced back to when members of St. Andrews society and the Sons of Scotland promoted the idea of a full Highlander regiment in Hamilton. The regiment has served in both World Wars, the Korean War, and in Afghanistan. The ASHC is also active in the community, participating in parades, ceremonies, and other events.

The Argyll and Sutherland Highlanders' motto is "Albainn Gu Brath," which is Scottish Gaelic for "Scotland forever." This motto reflects the unit's Scottish heritage and its commitment to upholding the traditions of the Highland regiments.

The Royal Highland Fusiliers of Canada (Cambridge and Kitchener)

One of Canada's oldest infantry regiments. The Royal Highland Fusiliers of Canada (RHFC) is a Reserve unit from the Canadian Forces 31 Canadian Brigade Group, with companies in Cambridge and Kitchener. The regiment can trace its history back to the war of 1812, when the unit became part of the fabric of the Waterloo region through the hauling of supplies to support the war effort. The Regiment and its soldiers have continued to serve Canada's interests worldwide in peace support operations including

Egypt, Cyprus, Cambodia, Namibia, the former Republic of Yugoslavia and, most recently, Afghanistan, Darfur, and, most recently, Ukraine, Iraq and Latvia.

The Royal Highland Fusiliers of Canada's motto is "Defence not Defiance." This motto reflects the Regiment's steadfast commitment to protecting and safeguarding Canada and its people, prioritizing a posture of readiness and resilience over aggression.

The Royal Hamilton Light Infantry (Wentworth Regiment) (Hamilton and Burlington)

Established on December 11, 1862, as the 13th Battalion Volunteer Militia, The Royal Hamilton Light Infantry (Wentworth Regiment) (RHLI) is the oldest infantry regiment in the Hamilton-Burlington area. The RHLI has been present in every Canadian military campaign and the history of the Regiment reflects the history of the nation it serves.

"Rileys", as they are known, were present at the Battle of Ridgeway during the Fenian Raids, the Red River uprising and the Boer War. In both World Wars, Rileys distinguished themselves, and members also served in Korea. Rileys have also served in the former Republic of Yugoslavia, Kuwait, The Congo, Sierra Leone, Haiti and Afghanistan.

The Royal Hamilton Light Infantry's (RHLI) motto is "Semper Paratus," which translates as "Always Ready." This motto reflects the RHLI's unwavering commitment to maintaining a high state of readiness, ensuring they are prepared to deploy and fight at a moment's notice to defend Canada and its interests.

The Grey and Simcoe Foresters (Owen Sound and Barrie)

The Grey and Simcoe Foresters are a Primary Reserve infantry regiment, based in Barrie and Owen Sound, Ontario, with a long and storied history of serving Canada. The current regiment was formed by the amalgamation in 1936 of two county-based militia regiments - the Grey Regiment and the Simcoe Foresters. Both of these regiments predate the foundation of Canada itself. The modern regiment thus perpetuates units which served in the Northwest Rebellion and the First World War and was awarded its most recent battle honour - AFGHANISTAN - in 2014. Individual members of the regiment have seen service in Boer War, the First and Second World Wars, Korea, UN peacekeeping missions and in Afghanistan. Currently, the Grey and Simcoe Foresters are responsible for the generation of 4 Canadian Division's Arctic Response Company Group (ARCG). This involves the maintenance of an arctic warfare capability and regular training missions in The Grey and Simcoe Foresters' motto is "Tenacious and Versatile." This motto reflects the Regiment's unwavering commitment to adaptability and perseverance in the face of adversity, embodying their ability to overcome challenges and achieve victory in any environment or situation. Canada's far North.

Subheader: Artillery

The role of the Artillery Corps is to provide fire support to maneuver forces, neutralizing enemy positions and disrupting their operations. Arty soldiers are experts in operating a variety of weapon systems, from howitzers and mortars to rocket launchers and missiles. Their precision and firepower are crucial to achieving victory on the battlefield.

11th Field Artillery Regiment, RCA (Guelph and Hamilton)

Artillery has been present in Canada from the days of the first colonists. 11th Field Regiment is a reserve unit from the Canadian Forces 31 Canadian Brigade Group, whose task is to augment Canada's Regular Force military by providing indirect artillery support. In Wellington County, the 11th Field Artillery Regiment evolved out of the traditional county militia structure. This Reserve Force regiment originated in Guelph, Ontario on 24 March 1880, when the '1st Provisional Brigade of Field Artillery' was authorized to be formed. Members of the regiment have served proudly through both World Wars, the Korean War, the Balkans and Afghanistan.

11th Field Artillery Regiment's motto is "Ubique. Quo Fas et Gloria Ducunt," which translates as "Everywhere. Where Right and Glory Lead." This motto reflects the Regiment's dedication to serving wherever duty calls, upholding the values of honor and courage in their unwavering support of the Canadian Armed Forces.

Subheader: Engineers

Engineers provide a wide range of support for the Canadian Army, from constructing field fortifications and bridges to clearing obstacles and detecting mines. Engineers are problem solvers and innovators, using their technical skills and ingenuity to overcome challenges on the battlefield. Their work is essential to the mobility, survivability, and overall success of military operations. Engineers play a crucial role in shaping the battlefield and enabling the Army to achieve its objectives.

31 Combat Engineer Regiment (The Elgin's) (St. Thomas and Waterloo)

31 Combat Engineer Regiment (The Elgins) (31 CER) is a reserve unit of the Canadian Armed Forces, supporting 31 Canadian Brigade Group. It consists of two squadrons: 7 Engineer Squadron in St. Thomas, Ontario, and 48 Engineer Squadron in Waterloo, Ontario. Tracing its roots back to 1866 as the 25th (Elgin) Battalion of Infantry, the regiment has deployed soldiers to all major conflicts. This continues to the present day, with "Elgins" deploying to Iraq, Afghanistan, Latvia, and Ukraine. 31 CER also supports domestic operations, sending personnel and equipment across Canada, such as for Op LENTUS.

31 Combat Engineer Regiment's motto is "Ubique. Quo Fas et Gloria Ducunt," which translates as "Everywhere. Where Right and Glory Lead." This motto reflects the Regiment's dedication to serving wherever duty calls, upholding the values of honor and courage in their unwavering support of the Canadian Armed Forces.

Subheader: Armoured

The Royal Canadian Armoured Corps provides mobile firepower and shock action on the battlefield. Armoured soldiers are experts in operating tanks and other armoured vehicles, using their speed, agility, and firepower to overwhelm enemy positions and disrupt their operations. The job demands technical expertise, teamwork, and a willingness to operate in high-intensity combat situations. It is, however, highly rewarding and offers a unique opportunity to be at the forefront of operations and make a decisive impact on the battlefield.

1st Hussars (London and Sarnia)

The 1st Hussars is a Primary Reserve Armoured Reconnaissance Regiment of the Canadian Army. As part of 31 Canadian Brigade Group, the Regiment is based in London and Sarnia and provides the Brigade with highly motivated and trained armoured crewmen. The 1st Hussars has a long and storied history; founded in 1856 with the formation of the First London Volunteer Troop of Cavalry. Through the amalgamation of several troops in southwestern Ontario, the 1st Regiment of Cavalry was formed on 29 May 1872. In April 1892 the Regiment was redesignated the First Hussars and thus became the Canadian Cavalry Regiment which has held its name longer than any other. 31 Combat Engineer Regiment's motto is "Ubique. Quo Fas et Gloria Ducunt," which translates as "Everywhere. Where Right and Glory Lead." This motto reflects the Regiment's dedication to serving wherever duty calls, upholding the values of honor and courage in their unwavering support of the Canadian Armed Forces.

The Windsor Regiment (RCAC)

The Windsor Regiment (RCAC) is a Land Force Reserve reconnaissance regiment that originated in Windsor, Ontario on 15 December 1936. The Windsor Regiment is a unit from the Canadian Forces 31 Canadian Brigade Group, whose task is to augment Canada's military by providing trained Armoured Reconnaissance soldiers. Members of the Regiment have served with distinction, deploying in both World Wars, participating in Korean war, and from 2002 to 2014, reinforcing various CAF units deployed to Afghanistan.

The Windsor Regiment's motto is "Semper Paratus," which translates as "Always Ready." This motto reflects the Regiment's unwavering commitment to maintaining a high state of readiness, ensuring they are prepared to deploy and fight at a moment's notice to defend Canada and its interests.

(Page 7-8 – AO Map)

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(Currently being designed)

(Pages 9-10 – Exercises & Operations: Domestic)

Header: OPERATIONS & EXERCISES

Subheader: 31 CBG: Leading the Charge – Training, Service, and Community

From the shores of Lake Huron to the heart of Southwestern Ontario, the soldiers of 31 Canadian Brigade Group (31 CBG) have consistently demonstrated their dedication to serving Canada on both the homefront and abroad. Recent years have been no exception, marked by rigorous training exercises, diverse domestic operations, and continued engagement with our communities across Southwestern Ontario. Our soldiers, hailing from all walks of life, brought their unique skills and experiences to bear in a time filled with challenges and opportunities.

As one of three brigade groups under 4 Division, 31 CBG plays a unique role in the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF), bridging the gap between military service and civilian life. Our soldiers are your neighbors, your colleagues, and your friends, stepping up to serve when their country calls. This past year, we've strengthened our bonds with the communities we serve, participating in local events, supporting youth programs, and sharing our stories to foster understanding and appreciation for the CAF.

Whether responding to natural disasters, aiding in pandemic relief efforts, or partnering with Indigenous communities, 31 CBG has proven its adaptability and unwavering commitment to the safety and well-being of Canadians. This section of the magazine will delve deeper into the specific exercises and operations that define us, highlighting the individuals and units that make 31 CBG a force to be reckoned with.

Subheader: Weekend Warrior – Train How You Fight

Throughout the training year, 31 CBG participates in a series of challenging exercises designed to enhance our skills, foster interoperability, and deepen our connection with the communities we serve. These exercises simulate a wide range of scenarios, from large-scale combat operations to natural disasters and community engagement initiatives. Brigade exercises occur during specific times of the year and allow for the various units and elements of 31 CBG to coordinate and collaborate in collective training. During training year, Reservist Subunit training transpires every week and is marked by an exercise once a month.

Arrowhead Guardian: Each August 31 CBG soldiers test their mettle in Exercise Arrowhead Guardian, a demanding war-fighting exercise that sharpens our tactical skills and strengthens our

ability to operate in complex environments. This training is essential for maintaining our operational readiness and ensuring we are prepared to defend Canada and its interests.

Glacial Arrowhead: The harsh conditions of Northern Ontario and the Arctic provide the backdrop for Exercise Glacial Arrowhead, a NOREX (Northern Exercise) held in March and April. Here, our soldiers brave extreme cold and rugged terrain, mastering the skills required for winter warfare and survival. Engaging with remote communities fosters mutual respect and cultural understanding, strengthening our relationships with Indigenous peoples.

Trillium Venture: This exercise focuses on preparing 31 CBG to respond effectively to natural disasters, such as floods and fires, in urban environments. By simulating realistic scenarios and working alongside civilian emergency responders, we enhance our ability to coordinate and deliver aid when it matters most. Trillium Venture also serves as a platform to educate the public about the role of the Canadian Armed Forces in disaster response, raising awareness and building resilience within our communities.

Subheader: Answering the Call to Serve at Home

31 CBG remains steadfast in our commitment to supporting Canadians in times of need. Our soldiers have answered the call to serve in several domestic operations over the years.

Responding to Natural Disasters:

When natural disasters strike, 31 CBG is ready to deploy rapidly and provide critical assistance to affected communities. Whether it's floods, fires, or other emergencies, our soldiers work tirelessly alongside civilian agencies to evacuate residents, provide essential supplies, and restore critical infrastructure. Our expertise in logistics, engineering, and medical support enables us to make a tangible difference in the lives of those impacted by these events.

Example: *Operation LENTUS*: Operation working alongside civilian agencies to construct flood barriers, evacuate residents from danger zones, and provide essential supplies to those in need.

Building Stronger Communities:

31 CBG is deeply committed to fostering strong relationships with Indigenous communities and other diverse groups across our area of operations. We collaborate with community partners on a range of initiatives, including infrastructure development, emergency response planning, and cultural exchange programs. By working together, we build trust, promote understanding, and strengthen the resilience of our communities.

Supporting Public Health Initiatives:

During the COVID-19 pandemic, 31 CBG personnel played a vital role in supporting public health efforts. Our medical professionals and support staff deployed to vaccination clinics and long-term care facilities, assisting with testing, vaccination administration, and patient care. We

also provided logistical support and expertise in managing complex operations, ensuring that critical resources were delivered efficiently and effectively.

Example: Operation LASER was the Canadian Armed Forces' (CAF) response to a worldwide pandemic situation.

Subheader: *Always Looking Forward*

Through our domestic operations, 31 CBG demonstrates the Canadian Armed Forces' commitment to serving and protecting Canadians. Our soldiers embody the values of professionalism, integrity, and compassion, making a positive impact on the lives of countless individuals and communities across the country. We stand ready to answer the call, wherever and whenever it comes, to ensure the safety, security, and well-being of all Canadians.

As we move forward, 31 CBG will continue to adapt our training and capabilities to meet the ever-evolving challenges facing our nation and the world. Our soldiers remain dedicated to upholding the highest standards of professionalism, readiness, and service.

Subheader: International Operations - 31 CBG: Answering the Global Call – A Year of International Service

The soldiers of 31 CBG stand ready to serve Canada not only on the homefront but also on the international stage. In the past year, our members deployed on four significant operations, showcasing their expertise, adaptability, and unwavering commitment to global peace and security.

Operation REASSURANCE: Bolstering NATO's Eastern Flank

31 CBG personnel joined their Regular Force counterparts in Operation REASSURANCE, Canada's contribution to NATO's enhanced Forward Presence in Central and Eastern Europe. Deployed to Latvia, our soldiers integrated into a multinational battlegroup, conducting training exercises, patrolling borders, and deterring potential aggression. This mission underscored our commitment to collective defense and the preservation of peace in the region.

Example: 31 CBG's combat engineers played a crucial role in constructing defensive fortifications and obstacles, ensuring the battlegroup's readiness to respond to any threats.

Operation IMPACT: Fighting Terrorism in the Middle East

31 CBG soldiers deployed to the Middle East as part of Operation IMPACT, Canada's contribution to the Global Coalition against Daesh. Our personnel provided training, advice, and assistance to local security forces, empowering them to combat terrorism and stabilize the region. Additionally, our medical professionals delivered essential care to both military personnel and local civilians, showcasing our commitment to humanitarian aid.

Example: 31 CBG's intelligence operators played a key role in analyzing threats and identifying potential targets, contributing to the overall success of counter-terrorism efforts.

Operation UNIFIER: Building Capacity in Ukraine

In Ukraine, 31 CBG members participated in Operation UNIFIER, Canada's military training and capacity-building mission. Our soldiers shared their expertise in combat skills, leadership development, and medical training, empowering Ukrainian security forces to defend their country's sovereignty and territorial integrity. This mission underscored our unwavering support for Ukraine and its people.

Example: 31 CBG's infantry instructors trained Ukrainian soldiers in advanced combat tactics and techniques, enhancing their ability to operate effectively in challenging environments.

Operation CARIBBE: Counter-Narcotics Operations in the Caribbean

31 CBG personnel joined the Canadian Armed Forces' contribution to Operation CARIBBE, a multinational effort to disrupt transnational criminal organizations involved in drug trafficking in the Caribbean Sea and Eastern Pacific Ocean. Our soldiers served aboard naval vessels, conducting maritime patrols, boarding suspect vessels, and seizing illicit drugs. This operation demonstrated our commitment to regional security and the fight against organized crime.

Example: 31 CBG's naval boarding party members played a vital role in intercepting drug smugglers, seizing large quantities of cocaine and other narcotics.

(Page 11-12 – Strong. Proud. Ready: Public Engagement and highlights)

Note: This section will be heavy on photos showcasing the various public outreach and community events conducted by 31 CBG and its various subunits.

Subheader: Strong. Proud. Ready. 31 Brigade's Year of Community Connection

The soldiers of 31 Canadian Brigade Group (31 CBG) aren't just defenders of Canada – we're also proud members of the communities we serve. In 2023, we deepened our connection with our fellow citizens through a wide array of public outreach and engagement activities. Here's a look back at some of the highlights:

Fostering Future Leaders: Cadet and Youth Programs

31 CBG recognizes the importance of inspiring the next generation of leaders and community members. Our soldiers actively mentor and support numerous cadet corps and youth programs across Southwestern Ontario. We provide training, mentorship, and opportunities for young people to develop valuable skills in leadership, teamwork, and self-discipline.

- **Cadet Summer Training Centres:** 31 CBG personnel served as instructors and staff at various cadet summer training centers, sharing their expertise in everything from marksmanship to survival skills. These experiences empower cadets to reach their full potential and become active, engaged citizens.
- **Youth Outreach Events:** All across Southwestern Ontario, we participated in community events like career fairs, school visits, and youth leadership conferences, sharing our experiences in the Canadian Armed Forces and inspiring young people to explore their own paths to service.

Honoring Our Veterans: Remembrance Day Ceremonies

31 CBG is deeply committed to honoring the sacrifices of our veterans and ensuring their stories are remembered. We actively participated in Remembrance Day ceremonies across the region, laying wreaths, providing honor guards, and engaging with veterans and their families. These solemn occasions remind us of the cost of freedom and the importance of preserving our shared history.

Community Parades and Festivals:

Bringing a touch of military tradition and pageantry to local events, 31 CBG soldiers marched in numerous parades and festivals throughout the year. These events not only showcase our pride in our service but also provide opportunities for us to interact with our fellow citizens, answer questions, and build stronger connections with the communities we call home.

Open Houses and Demonstrations:

We opened our doors to the public for several open house events across the province, offering a glimpse into the training, equipment, and daily life of 31 CBG soldiers. These events featured interactive displays, vehicle demonstrations, and opportunities to meet and chat with our personnel. They also served as valuable recruitment tools, inspiring potential recruits to consider a fulfilling career in the Canadian Armed Forces.

Building a Stronger Community Together

At 31 CBG, we believe that our strength lies not only in our military capabilities but also in the bonds we forge with our fellow citizens. The Brigade maintains an active presence on social media platforms like Facebook and Instagram. Through regular posts, we share updates on our activities, highlight the accomplishments of our soldiers, and provide a behind-the-scenes look at life in our organization. Through our public outreach and engagement activities, we strive to build trust, understanding, and mutual respect. We are proud to be part of the fabric of our communities, and we look forward to continuing to strengthen these connections in the years to come.

End of Magazine